PRAYER SERIES AT TIFERET EYAL

Sacrificing Sacrifices: Will Animal Offerings Return?

Prayer Series, Part 6

Series: Prayer Series (Tiferet Eyal, 2021-22) **Shiur:** Part 6 of the six-part Prayer Series, given by Dayan Daniel Kada on Zoom for Tiferet Eyal, Tuesday 18 January 2022

These notes are based on an automatic transcript of the recording.

Recap and Plan

The final shiur of the series. So far: the history and theology of prayer; the Siddur from the beginning; the Shema with creation, revelation and redemption; the Amidah and the ways of repeating it; and last week, the Torah reading: "how we talk to God through prayer, and God talks to us in Torah reading," its origins with Moshe and Ezra, Monday and Thursday, the annual and triennial cycles, aliyot, Kohen and Levi, and women being called up.

Tonight: a few remaining points on the **Torah and Haftarah**, then **Musaf** and **sacrifices in messianic times**, ending with **Aleinu LeShabeach**, "a very enigmatic tefillah" that we say three times a day.

Part 1: The Mashlim Kaddish Is Not for Mourners

The Rabbi wanted to correct a widespread idea. Many people think that if they have a *yahrzeit* (*nahala*) they must be called up for the seventh aliyah, the **mashlim**, and say the Kaddish after it, "and if not, then trouble will break loose."

- **Mashlim** simply means "completing": it completes the seven aliyot.
- The Kaddish after it is there to make a **break between the Torah reading and the Haftarah**, the reading of the Prophets.
- The idea that this Kaddish elevates the soul of the deceased developed only about a hundred years ago. "It's got nothing to do with that in the slightest." Nowhere in our liturgy is a **half Kaddish** designated for mourners. Mourners' Kaddish is always Kaddish Yehe Shelama or Kaddish Al Yisrael.
- So the idea that a mourner must be called seventh is "nonsensical, to be honest." If someone with a yahrzeit is called up and says it, lovely, but there is no obligation.
- The reverse is also untrue: some people called up seventh, whose parents are alive, refuse to say the Kaddish for fear it will cause their parents to die. "That's also nonsense." Anyone may say it.

Part 2: Children Reading the Torah

The Shulchan Aruch rules clearly that a child may be called up and read his own portion, as we saw last week alongside the halacha about women. "This is absolutely black and white." The child must be of the age of **chinuch**, about six or seven. In **Yemenite** communities across the world this is common practice.

A child reading **more than his own aliyah**, for example the whole parashah, should be only in extenuating circumstances, when no one else can read, or for educational purposes.

Part 3: The Haftarah

What the word means

הפטרה comes from the root **פ־ט־ר**, to dismiss or depart. We now depart from the Torah and begin something of lesser importance, the Prophets.

Why was it instituted?

The Mishnah and Gemara in the fourth chapter of **Megillah** (which Daf Yomi learners had just studied) discuss the Haftarah at length, but nowhere give a reason for adding a reading from the Prophets after the parashah. The Rishonim offer three explanations:

Source	Reason
Abudarham (fourteenth-century Spain)	**Antiochus**, of Hanukkah infamy, forbade public reading of the Torah, but apparently not the Prophets. So we read passages from the Prophets on the theme of the parashah, and kept the custom even after the Torah reading resumed
Shibbolei HaLeket (Rabbi Tzidkiyah ben Avraham, thirteenth-century Rome)	Originally people stayed after prayers each day to study Torah and Prophets. When they no longer had the time, this was cut down to a few fixed verses from the Prophets, **Uva LeTzion**, after the Amidah. To compensate for the lost weekday study, the Prophets are read on Shabbat
Another explanation in the Rishonim	To counter those, such as the **Samaritans**, who held that the Torah is only the five books. Reading the Prophets after the Torah shows they are an essential part of our Torah

The Rabbi found the first "very difficult to accept": why would the Greeks object to the Torah but not the Prophets? And the Hanukkah story is early second century BCE. Still, it is one theory.

The Rabbi's own suggestion

"On a personal level, I would suggest a very simple idea." The Prophets are **rich in musar**, rebuke and chastisement. The Torah is Hashem speaking through Moshe; a prophet's words are Hashem's message, but "with their own touch." Yeshayahu, Yirmiyahu and Yechezkel each have their own style and tone, and reading them can arouse a person. Shabbat, after the Torah reading, was a good time to hear some musar.

"Basically this was the Rabbi's sermon in those days, before the concept of the Rabbi's sermon came along... To be honest, if you read the Nevi'im, that's sometimes more powerful than any sermon, if you read it properly."

Part 4: Mi Sheberach and the Prayer for the Government

Mother's name or father's name?

People often ask whether to pray for someone with the father's or the mother's name. "It's very simple." The **Gemara in Shabbat (66b)**, which the Rabbi showed on screen, records Amoraim praying with the formula **פלוני בר פלונית**, "so-and-so son of **Mrs** so-and-so." **When praying for someone, use the mother's name.** Why?

- **Flora: רחמים**, mercy, shares a root with **רחם**, the womb. "Lovely, that's a very nice idea."
- **The Rishonim**, on a simpler, technical level: you are more certain who a person's mother is than his father. The mother is seen giving birth; the father is normally, "but not always," her husband. It is the more direct biological link.
- **The Ben Ish Chai**, in his responsa **Torah Lishmah**: men have more sins than women. Women go through the difficulties of childbirth, which is their *tikkun*, and men, with a greater obligation to study Torah, end up wasting more time from Torah. So women find greater favour in Hashem's eyes, and when asking for mercy it is better to attribute a person to his mother.

The exception is an aliyah to the Torah, where we use the father's name, since aliyot today are for men. **Hacham Ovadia Yosef** has a responsum: it makes no real difference; the mother's name is better, but those with an established custom to use the father's name (for example in memorial prayers) may keep it. Some in the Indian community use the mother's name for the first thirty days and the father's afterwards, or vice versa. "If you have an established minhag, stick to the minhag. But otherwise, by default, you always use the mother's name."

The prayer for the Royal Family

Many communities, including the Spanish and Portuguese, say a prayer for the Royal Family. It rests on the Prophets and the Mishnah:

- **Yirmiyahu** tells the exiles: settle down, **seek the peace of the city** where I have exiled you, and **pray for it**, for in its peace you will have peace.
- **Pirkei Avot: pray for the welfare of the government**, for without it people would not behave well.

One could argue that, since the monarchy has little real authority today, it would make more sense to pray for the Prime Minister, "which he probably needs lots of our prayers at the moment," and the government. But the prayer was instituted when the monarch was fully sovereign, and we keep it. "I think it's a valuable prayer," going all the way back to Yirmiyahu.

Part 5: Musaf

An additional prayer for an additional offering

Musaf dates from the time of **Ezra**, about 2,500 years ago. On Shabbat, festivals and Rosh Chodesh an extra offering, the **musaf** ("addition"), was brought beyond the daily morning and afternoon sacrifices.

As explained in the first shiur, **Shacharit and Mincha correspond to the daily morning and afternoon offerings**, brought 365 days a year. **Arvit has no sacrificial counterpart**, which is why it is of lower importance than Shacharit and Mincha. So although Arvit is more frequent, **Musaf ranks above Arvit**, because it is more directly linked to the Temple offerings.

Korban: coming close

קרבן comes from **קרוב**, to draw near. A sacrifice was not just slaughtering an animal but **surrendering something of ourselves** to the One greater than us. As with prayer (Part 1), it is not asking Hashem to do our will; it is pledging ourselves to do His. "The actual sacrificial ritual in itself is worthless." That is why the Prophets castigate people who brought sacrifices without their hearts:

- **Amos, chapter 5:** "I hate, I reject your festivals... your burnt offerings... your peace offerings I will not look at. Take away the noise of your songs... But let **justice roll down like water, and righteousness like a mighty stream**."
- **Yeshayahu, chapter 1** (read on the Shabbat before Tisha B'Av): "Who asked you to trample My courts?... Bring no more vain offerings... Your new moons and your festivals My soul hates... **Wash yourselves, make yourselves clean**, remove your evil deeds... uphold the orphan, plead for the widow."

"The truth is, prayer today is the same idea. We pray to Hashem, and then we go out and commit wrongdoings to our fellow friends, and we think if we pray to HaKadosh Baruch Hu we'll be fine... When something becomes too ritualistic, then we lose the focus."

Part 6: Will Animal Sacrifices Return?

The core of Musaf is the prayer for the **Temple to be rebuilt and the offerings restored**. We describe what was offered on Shabbat or Rosh Chodesh and ask that it be renewed. So when the Third Temple is built, speedily in our days, will we go back to animal sacrifices?

The mainstream view

The majority of Orthodox Jews will say yes: we await the rebuilding of the Temple and the restoration of animal sacrifices. What about animal welfare? The typical answer: if we kill animals to eat meat for physical pleasure, surely we may for sacrificial purposes. We care for animals, but they are secondary to human beings, and if a sacrifice furthers human worship of the Divine it is justified. "And I must say, that's the mainstream opinion."

The Rambam: a concession

But there are other voices, most prominently **the Rambam in the Moreh Nevuchim (3:32)**, which the Rabbi quoted at length because it is a general principle the Rambam returns to

repeatedly.

- "Many precepts in our law are the result of a similar course... **It is impossible to go suddenly from one extreme to the other.**" (As we learned last year in Hilchot Deot: you cannot change your character overnight.) It is human nature that a person cannot suddenly abandon everything he is used to.
- In those days, the universal mode of worship was sacrificing animals in temples, bowing to images and burning incense to idols.
- "It was in accordance with the wisdom and plan of God, as displayed in the whole creation, that **He did not command us to give up and discontinue all these manners of service**," because that would go against human nature.
- It would have been like a prophet today telling us in Hashem's name not to pray, not to fast, not to seek His help in times of trouble.

Imagine a verified prophet telling us: stop praying, don't fast on Yom Kippur. We would say it's impossible; we're too used to it. So too, Hashem saw it would be impossible to tell Bnei Yisrael simply to stop sacrificing. Instead: "To blot out idolatry, I'm telling you, you can't serve the idols. But continue bringing sacrifices, as many as you want, but bring them just to Me." It is "a kind of concession."

The Ramban famously took the Rambam to task: you are effectively saying the whole of Sefer Vayikra is a concession! For the Ramban, sacrifices are Hashem's will and will always exist. But using the Rambam one could argue that by the time of the Third Temple, having been "weaned" off sacrifices for two thousand years, we will no longer need them and will serve Hashem without them. The difficulty is that we mention the sacrifices in our prayers every Shabbat.

Rav Kook: a minchah offering

Rav Kook, the first Ashkenazi Chief Rabbi of then-Palestine (died 1935), pointed to the verse in **Malachi, chapter 3**, about the messianic era: **וערבה לה׳ מנחת יהודה וירושלים**, "then the offering of Yehudah and Yerushalayim will be pleasing to Hashem." On a simple level *minchah* means a gift or offering in general. Rav Kook took it literally: in Parashat Vayikra a *minchah* is specifically a **flour offering**. In messianic times, all the sacrifices will be replaced by **menachot**, flour offerings, without killing animals. So wherever our prayers mention sacrifices, that is how it was historically; in the time of Mashiach they will be flour offerings.

This must be understood in the context of Rav Kook's philosophy (the Rabbi has written about this). He held that vegetarianism was the human ideal, **aspirationally**, but not for now: if we don't take our pleasure from animals, we will end up harming human beings. "It's well known, by the way, the various prominent Nazis were vegetarians." So the references to animal sacrifice in the prayer book are either flour offerings or belong to the very beginning of the messianic era, before the vegetarian ideal can be realised.

Others say similar things: **Rabbi Chaim Hirschensohn**, a nineteenth-century posek, in **Malki BaKodesh**, writes that the system will undergo significant changes, with a different concept of sacrifices in messianic times.

Wait and see

"We can't deny that that is the mainstream opinion. But there are other voices, such as the Rambam, such as Rav Kook, such as others, who understand that it's not as simple as you think it is. There will be a temple, there will be a form of sacrifices, but it won't be the animal kind of sacrifices."

The most important thing is not the sacrifices themselves but the **kavanat halev** that comes with them. "I think we'll just wait and see." We pray for the Beit HaMikdash, and to restore in some way the concept of offerings: ways of coming close to Hashem by sacrificing our money and material possessions to Him.

Question: Shacharit, Mincha and Arvit are linked to the Avot. Is there one for Musaf? "No, definitely not." The Gemara in Berachot speaks of the Avot only in connection with Shacharit, Mincha and Arvit. "Although it would be nice, Musaf and Yosef, I'm sure you can find some kind of connection there."

Part 7: Aleinu LeShabeach

"I think it's one of the most misunderstood parts of our liturgy." In almost every siddur, Aleinu and its second paragraph, **על כן נקוה לך**, close Shacharit, Mincha and Arvit. **Spanish and Portuguese siddurim do not include *Al Ken Nekaveh*.**

Originally only on Rosh Hashanah

People think the Malchuyot section of **Musaf of Rosh Hashanah** borrowed Aleinu from the daily prayers. "Nothing could be further from the truth." Aleinu **started only in Musaf of Rosh Hashanah**, said once or twice a year. The first formal siddur, **Rav Amram Gaon's** (ninth century), has no Aleinu at the end of weekday or Shabbat services.

How it reached the daily prayers

- The first mention of Aleinu **at the end of Shacharit** is in the **Machzor Vitry** by **Rabbeinu Simcha**, a student of Rashi. He says to say it **silently**, without giving a reason. Read the English: it speaks sharply of blotting out idolatry and that there is only one God, with some anti-Christian references. Living in France surrounded by Christians, it makes sense to say it quietly, "because it's not the kindest of prayers to other religions."
- **Why add it?** It has been suggested that in **1171**, in **Blois** in France, Jewish men and women were burnt at the stake for refusing to accept Christianity, and the legend has it they died with **Aleinu LeShabeach on their lips**. Christian Europe added it to the end of Shacharit in their memory.
- Only later, around the fourteenth and fifteenth centuries, was it added to **Mincha and Arvit**. The reason: the **Gemara in Berachot** says that after the Amidah you should not just run off, but take a moment before departing from Hashem. **The Rambam** codifies sitting for a moment to contemplate before going to work (he does not mention Aleinu at all). Aleinu became a way to bring you back down to this world after your encounter with the Divine.

"The problem is today, that's not the case. Aleinu LeShabeach is what you say whilst you're folding up your tallit, or whilst you're walking on your way out. And it's just a shame, because

Aleinu LeShabeach is such a beautiful prayer." Because we say it so often, it even loses its impact on Rosh Hashanah.

Who wrote it?

Flora had learned that it was **Yehoshua**, and mentioned the custom of spitting at a certain line, which she had seen in Gibraltar. The Rishonim give three opinions:

Author	Source	The Rabbi's comment
Yehoshua, when uprooting the idolatrous Canaanites on entering the land: **שלא שמנו כמשפחות האדמה**	First suggested by **Rabbi Yehudah HaChasid** (Germany, twelfth century)	Difficult: the prayer calls Hashem **הקדוש ברוך הוא**, a Talmudic phrase found nowhere in Tanach
Rav (third century), as part of the Rosh Hashanah prayers he composed	**Abudarham**	"Makes a lot of sense." It is post-Christianity: the "families of the earth" who worship **הבל וריק**, vanity and emptiness. And **לראות מהרה בתפארת עזך**, "to see speedily the splendour of Your strength," is to the Rabbi clearly a reference to the Mikdash, destroyed a century or two earlier
The **Men of the Great Assembly**, about 2,500 years ago, with the general prayers	Another opinion	

Why the Spanish and Portuguese say only half

Saying Aleinu after the prayers is late and **not an obligation**. The **Arizal** insisted especially on the **second paragraph**. Since the Spanish and Portuguese reject anything kabbalistically inclined, they say only the first. People ask how one can say only half of Aleinu, but historically saying both paragraphs was not common practice until around the sixteenth century or later. "So it makes sense, the minhag to only say the first paragraph."

The Takeaway From the Whole Series

"The main takeaway which I would like everyone to take away from this whole series, from all the history which we've seen, is how fluid our liturgy and tefillah is."

Today the liturgy feels set in stone, and any suggested change meets harsh opposition. But over three thousand years it has evolved dramatically.

- **Tefillah is the Amidah:** five to ten minutes, three times a day. "That's the core of tefillah. Everything else is all a nice way to envelop the tefillah."
- As we said in the first shiur, **HaKadosh Baruch Hu wants the heart.** It doesn't matter how much or how little you say; what matters is the kavanah.

"If a person honestly and genuinely believes that by saying less he will have more kavanah, then I have no question at all that's the right thing to do. Better to say less with kavanah, which is the Amidah, rather than pray the entire Siddur, which has been added on each generation, and just race through it."

Question: is the minimum just the Amidah? No. The core of tefillah is the **Amidah and the Shema with its blessings**, at Shacharit and at Arvit too. What the Rabbi meant is Pesukei DeZimrah and Korbanot: "If you have a choice to pray for fifteen minutes with kavanah, choose Amidah and Birkot Kriat Shema rather than praying in fifteen minutes from Pesukei DeZimrah, from Korbanot, and mumbling all from beginning to the end." Asked whether this differs for men and women: "No difference at all." Pesukei DeZimrah is a warm-up; as the Rambam writes, you say some *zemirot*, and you choose which.

Summary

1. **The mashlim Kaddish** separates Torah from Haftarah. It is not for mourners or yahrzeits, and people with living parents may say it.
2. **Children** of chinuch age (six or seven) may be called up and read their own aliyah (Shulchan Aruch); reading more only when needed or for education.
3. **Haftarah** (from *patar*, to depart): Antiochus (Abudarham, difficult), compensation for lost weekday study (Shibbolei HaLeket), or against those who denied the Prophets. The Rabbi: it was the sermon before sermons.
4. **Mi Sheberach:** use the **mother's name** (Gemara Shabbat 66b), except for an aliyah or an established custom (Hacham Ovadia; Ben Ish Chai). **The prayer for the government** goes back to Yirmiyahu and Pirkei Avot.
5. **Musaf** corresponds to the additional offering and so outranks Arvit. **Korban** means coming close; the Prophets (Amos 5, Yeshayahu 1) rejected sacrifice without the heart.
6. **Sacrifices in the Third Temple:** the mainstream view expects animal sacrifices; the **Rambam** (Moreh 3:32) saw them as a concession to human nature (opposed by the **Ramban**); **Rav Kook** (Malachi 3: *minchah*) expected flour offerings; also **Malki BaKodesh**. "We'll wait and see." No Avot for Musaf.
7. **Aleinu** began in Rosh Hashanah Musaf; reached Shacharit in Christian France (Machzor Vitry, said silently; Blois 1171) and Mincha/Arvit by the fourteenth or fifteenth century. Authorship: Yehoshua, Rav (most plausible), or the Men of the Great Assembly. The Spanish and Portuguese omit *Al Ken Nekaveh*, which the Arizal promoted.
8. **The series in one line:** the liturgy is fluid; the core is the Amidah and the Shema with its blessings; **better less with kavanah than everything in a rush.**

Coming Up

After a week's break, a **new series from Tuesday 1 February**: **dikduk** (Hebrew grammar), and **Makamim**, Middle Eastern hazanut, together with the world-class **Hazan David Raymond**.

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